

Monetization

Revenue streams:

- Hard currency sales
- Brand partnerships

Currencies:

- Hard currency (coins) - Used to purchase items in the in-game store. Can only be attained by cash payments.
- Soft currency (points) - Used to purchase player packs in the in-game store, unlock player upgrades, legend conversions, and trading players on the marketplace. Can be earned through gameplay rewards and by discarding/selling players on the marketplace.

Note: While soft currency cannot be directly purchased by users, the soft currency demand is directly tied to hard currency demand, as hard currency is a faster way to get hold of soft currency by purchasing players and discarding/selling them on the marketplace for soft currency. Therefore, while some game features are soft currency exclusive, they still have a direct effect on hard currency demand.

Store offers:

Included in launch:

- Player packs - priced in soft currency and hard currency
- Kits - priced in hard currency only
- Celebrations - priced in hard currency only

Post-launch:

- Footballs
- Originals packs - priced in hard currency only
- Stadiums
- Penalty run-ups (potentially part of player generation)

- Free kick run-ups (potentially part of player generation)
- Stadium customization assets
- Celebrity packs

Asset descriptions

Included in launch:

Player packs - Includes a number of unique players. Packs come with different types of guarantees - tier, potential, nationality, position, age, stats, etc. The number of players and the pack guarantees determines the price of a pack. Time-limited packs generally offer better value than the regular packs that are available at all times.

Kits - The clothing all players in a user's team will wear during a game and in the lobby. Users can assign any kit to either of their active slots (home/away). Each kit comes with a separate design for the goalkeeper. In the lobby, the user can select between their active kits for their own team, and select between the opponent's active kits for the opposing team.

Celebrations - Goal celebrations that can be triggered after scoring a goal. Users can set x celebrations to be active in team customization. Celebrations live on a team level, i. e. all active celebrations can be triggered by any player on the team after scoring a goal.

Originals packs - Includes one Original resembling a real-life footballer. Visuals for Originals are fixed to resemble the real-life footballer. Stats are unique just as for all other players, but are generated within ranges to ensure real-life characteristics are kept intact. Originals will generally have a fairly high starting rating, ~70-85+ depending on the player, and are subject to progression and aging just like all other players.

Originals packs could either guarantee a specific Original in the pack, or pick from a pool of Originals with different drop rates (e. g. Messi very low drop rate compared to Busquets). Ideally we'd prefer the pool-based approach, but that depends on the number of Originals we have available, and what the rev-share requirements look like. With the approach of having a specific Original guaranteed in a pack, the price point should differ based on the player.

Post-launch:

Footballs - Footballs that can be selected to be used in-game whenever the user plays a home game. The user can set one active football in team customization.

Stadiums - Stadiums that can be selected for the user's home games. The user can set one active stadium in team customization.

Penalty run-ups - Penalty run-ups that can be selected to be used in-game when one of the user's players takes a penalty. (TBD whether this should be part of player generation instead)

Free kick run-ups - Free kick run-ups that can be selected to be used in-game when one of the user's players takes a free kick. (TBD whether this should be part of player generation instead)

Stadium customization assets - Visual customization of stadiums. Nothing concrete planned yet, but could be things like tifos, grass, chants, goal music, etc.

Celebrity packs - Includes one player resembling a real-life celebrity. Similar to Originals, but with the difference that rating guarantees will generally be lower, and the stats are completely randomized as we don't have any real-life characteristics that we need to maintain. For certain celebrities a few sub-stats could be guaranteed (e. g. The Rock = 95+ strength guaranteed, or iShowSpeed = 85+ pace guaranteed or similar). Celebrities are subject to aging and progression just like all other players.

Similar to Originals, depending on the number we have available, and what rev-share guidelines allow, celebrity packs could either guarantee a specific celebrity, or pick from a pool of celebrities with different drop rates. To make celebrity packs more appealing, they could come with different rating guarantees at different price points. E. g. Basic+ being the cheapest alternative and Uncommon+ the most expensive.

Economic Drivers:

- Store items - Creates a direct demand for hard currency to be able to purchase store items.
Only player packs can be purchased with either soft currency or hard currency, all other items

are hard currency exclusive.

- Swaps - Increases the demand for players to be able to meet the swap criteria and get a reward in return. With time-limited swaps and custom requirements being added, more specific player types will be required to complete certain swaps, to further increase the demand. Any increase in demand for players increases the demand for soft and hard currency to get hold of new players.
- Tournaments - Tournaments with custom entry requirements increases the demand for players beyond your regular starting XI, as you'll need different types of players (nationality, age, Legend/active, team rating etc.) to enter tournaments.
- Challenges - Certain challenges have player-specific requirements to complete. For users who don't have a fit for the challenge, this results in a bigger demand for player packs to get hold of a player to complete the challenge(s).
- Marketplace - Increases the demand for soft currency to be able to purchase desirable players on the marketplace. Each trade on the marketplace also results in a 10% fee in soft currency, draining the ecosystem on soft currency.

An increase in soft currency demand translates to a bigger demand for hard currency as well. While users cannot directly purchase soft currency, they can get hold of it by using hard currency to purchase players to then discard, swap, or sell on the marketplace for soft currency.

- Progression system - To unlock player upgrades, users must pay with soft currency. The price depends on the current rating of the player, where higher rated players are more expensive to upgrade. This is a soft currency sink that helps to increase the demand for soft currency, leading to a bigger demand for hard currency as well.
- Legend conversion - Once a player retires they are no longer eligible to be used in gameplay. However, by converting a retired player to a legend, users can once again use the player in game modes where the entry requirements allow it. The legend conversion comes at a soft currency cost based on the player's rating, once again draining the ecosystem on soft currency and increasing the demand for hard currency to get hold of more soft currency.

Brand partnerships:

While not entirely my territory, the idea behind brand partnerships is to give exposure to brands that fit well with the GOALS identity in our game. Fortunately, having brands as part of the game is very natural in a football context, and there are several avenues that we could explore:

- *Stadium Branding*

Billboards & Banners: Brands on LED screens or billboards by the pitch side.

Stadium naming rights: A brand sponsoring the name of a stadium in the game, e. g. “Adidas Stadium” or similar.

Scoreboard: Animations or logos appearing during half-time or goal replays, either on the scoreboard or on the pitch.

- *Kits and Accessories*

Kits: Branded kits as part of the store offering - E. g. “Manchester United Home” or “Adidas Gold” kits.

Accessories: Branded accessories as part of player generation - boots, gloves, wristbands, etc.

Footballs - Branded footballs as part of the store offering

- Branded player packs and player cards

Player packs: Branded player packs that come at a discount, e. g. “Adidas Premium”

Player cards: Player cards that come in a branded player pack also comes with a custom player card design with the brand on it (still tier-based).

- *Broadcasts*

Replay Sponsorships: “Replay brought to you by” or similar.

Half-time: Graphics and/or commercials related to the brand.

Overlays: Branded overlays during games at official GOALS events.

- *Branded social media posts*

- *Game modes*

Game mode branding: e. g. GOALS x Kings League

Time-limited game modes: “Adidas Arena Challenge” or similar tied to a leaderboard with good rewards for those finishing high, and some rewards to everyone who participated.

- *Leaderboard Branding*

- *Game mode rewards*

Tokens: Branded in-game tokens that can be gathered as part of game mode/challenges/swaps rewards to be used in the store for exclusive items/packs.

- *Music*

In-game music: e. g. Spotify integration in the game (I believe EA are doing this for FC26).

Goal songs: Purchaseable goal songs from select artists/bands.

(Note: For brand partnerships, I am simply spitting ideas of how in-game integration could look like based on the current design. What/when we do these things is for someone else to decide).